

Ethical Governance & Risk in Agentic AI Implementation

Capstone Project: Construct an Ethical Governance Framework for AI Systems

To demonstrate mastery of ethical AI governance, you will design and present a comprehensive governance framework for a real or hypothetical AI system deployment. This project synthesizes all course learning objectives and requires you to apply theoretical knowledge to practical governance challenges.

Project Overview

You will create a complete governance framework for an AI system of your choice, addressing autonomy assessment, compliance strategy, and risk management. Your framework must be practical, implementable, and aligned with current regulatory requirements and ethical standards.

Project Components:

1. System Analysis and Autonomy Assessment (25% of grade)

- Detailed description of your chosen AI system and its intended use case
- Autonomy level assessment using the framework learned in Lesson 1
- Analysis of stakeholder impacts and ethical considerations
- Identification of key governance challenges specific to your system

2. Compliance and Regulatory Strategy (25% of grade)

→ Analysis of applicable regulatory frameworks (EU AI Act, NIST Framework, sector-specific regulations)

→ Design of adaptive compliance architecture that can evolve with changing regulations

→ Implementation timeline and resource requirements

→ Risk mitigation strategies for regulatory non-compliance

3. Risk Management and Governance Structure (25% of grade)

- Comprehensive risk assessment across technical, operational, ethical, regulatory, and reputational dimensions
- Governance organizational structure with clear roles and responsibilities
- Monitoring and oversight mechanisms for ongoing risk management
- Escalation procedures and incident response protocols

4. Implementation and Sustainability Plan (25% of grade)

Detailed implementation roadmap with phases, milestones, and success metrics

Change management strategy for organizational adoption

Training and capability building requirements

Long-term sustainability and evolution plan for the governance framework

Deliverable Format

Submit a comprehensive governance framework document (3,000-4,000 words) that includes:

- Executive summary with key recommendations
- All four project components with supporting analysis and justification
- Implementation timeline and resource requirements
- Appendices with relevant frameworks, templates, and tools

Completion Criteria:

→ Demonstrates comprehensive understanding of AI autonomy, compliance, and governance principles

→ Provides practical, implementable solutions aligned with current best practices

→ Shows sophisticated analysis of complex governance challenges

→ Integrates course concepts effectively with real-world application

→ Presents clear, professional documentation suitable for organizational use

Your capstone project should represent work that you could present to executive leadership or use as a foundation for actual AI governance implementation in your organization.